

PICKLING

Adults

Q

What is the minimum acidity percentage that vinegar must have for safe pickling?

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ANSWER

5% acidity

FUN FACT

Using vinegar with less than 5% acidity can allow harmful bacteria to grow in pickles.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

Why is it important not to reduce the amount of vinegar in a tested pickling recipe?

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ANSWER

Reducing vinegar lowers acidity and risks unsafe preservation

FUN FACT

Vinegar ensures the acidity needed to prevent bacterial growth in pickles.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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During fermentation of sauerkraut, what keeps the cabbage submerged to prevent spoilage?

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ANSWER

A weight pressing the cabbage under the brine

FUN FACT

Keeping vegetables submerged prevents mold growth during fermentation.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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What type of container is recommended for fermenting pickles and sauerkraut at home?

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ANSWER

Food-grade stoneware crock or glass container

FUN FACT

Using non-food-safe containers can cause contamination or unsafe food quality.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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How much pickling salt should you use per quart of water when preparing a brine for fermentation?

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ANSWER

**11/2 tablespoons per quart
water**

FUN FACT

Pickling salt is pure and free of additives that might cloud pickles or cause off-flavors.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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How long should cucumber slices be soaked in lime water for firmer pickles as a variation?

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ANSWER

12 to 24 hours

FUN FACT

Soaking in lime water makes the pickles crisp by strengthening their cell walls.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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What is the headspace recommended in jars when packing pickled vegetables before processing?

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ANSWER

1/2 inch headspace

FUN FACT

Proper headspace allows for food expansion and vacuum sealing during processing.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Which metal utensils should NOT be used with pickling due to reaction with acid or salt?

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ANSWER

**Zinc, copper, brass,
galvanized, or iron utensils**

FUN FACT

*Reactive metals can alter pickle color
and make food unsafe.*

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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What type of pickles require several weeks of room-temperature curing with bacteria producing lactic acid?

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ANSWER

Brined (fermented) pickles

FUN FACT

Fermented pickles develop complex flavors naturally from bacterial acid.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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At altitudes above 6,000 feet, how should processing times for pickles be adjusted in a boiling water canner?

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ANSWER

**Increase the processing time
(e.g., add 10 minutes)**

FUN FACT

Water boils at lower temperatures at high altitudes, requiring longer processing.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Which of these is the proper procedure to ensure safe pickling when using sugar in sweet pickle recipes?

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ANSWER

Boil sugar with vinegar and spices before adding vegetables

FUN FACT

Heating dissolves sugar and evenly distributes it to preserve flavor and safety.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Why should the blossom end of cucumbers be cut off before pickling?

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ANSWER

It contains enzymes that can cause softening of pickles

FUN FACT

Removing the blossom end helps keep pickles crisp longer.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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What is the role of salt in the brining solution for fermented pickles?

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ANSWER

To inhibit harmful bacteria and promote lactic acid bacteria growth

FUN FACT

Salt balances the environment so beneficial bacteria thrive during fermentation.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

Why is it unsafe to use garbage cans or non-food-grade containers for fermenting pickles?

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ANSWER

They may leach harmful chemicals or have toxic residues

FUN FACT

Only food-safe containers should touch your fermenting foods for safety.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

What is the recommended method to remove air bubbles from jars during packing pickles?

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ANSWER

Use a non-metallic spatula or plastic knife to gently release bubbles

FUN FACT

Removing air bubbles helps ensure proper vacuum sealing and prevents spoilage.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

For fresh pack pickles, what is the importance of heating the vinegar solution before packing cucumbers?

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ANSWER

It helps dissolve sugar and salt and kills surface bacteria

FUN FACT

Hot vinegar solution is necessary for food safety in quick pickles.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

In fermented vegetables like kimchi, what is the main acid produced during fermentation?

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ANSWER

Lactic acid

FUN FACT

Lactic acid gives fermented vegetables their tangy flavor and preserves them safely.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Which ingredient is essential for making marinated whole mushrooms safe and shelf-stable through pickling?

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ANSWER

Vinegar with 5% acidity

FUN FACT

Only vinegar at proper acidity ensures marinated vegetables are safely preserved.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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What is the recommended storage time after processing pickles before they develop ideal flavor?

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ANSWER

4 to 5 weeks

FUN FACT

Storage time allows flavors to meld and textures to improve in pickles.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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In pickling, what role does the sugar play besides flavor?

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ANSWER

Balances acidity and improves preservation taste

FUN FACT

Sugar helps soften the sharpness of vinegar for a balanced pickle flavor.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs